HUMAN RESOURCES · SEPARATION DOCUMENTATION

Exit Interview Record

Sara Fatima · Regional Manager · Interviewed by **Tahir Saleem** · 21 September 2026

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TENURE	DURATION	SEPARATION	INTERVIEW DATE
2.5 Years	24 Min	Voluntary	21 Sep

1 Employee Details

Employee Name	Sara Fatima
Designation	Regional Manager
Length of Service	Approximately 2.5 years
Interview Date & Mode	21 September 2026 — recorded video call (24 minutes)
Recording	fathom.video/share/8q6Hs4dJ5trsSUjgXBYxjiw982EG6KbF
Last Working Day	Not stated in the interview. She is expected in the office on 25 September.
Type of Separation	Voluntary. She has moved into a broader education-policy role.

2 Reasons for Leaving

A direct question on her reason for leaving was not put during the interview. The following is what she stated about her experience, in her own framing.

- Her summary of her 2.5 years was that **"there is no space for honesty and hard work in this office."**
- In her final months she began to feel like **a salesperson with a product to sell**, rather than someone meeting the needs of teachers and school heads.
- She said she had raised her concerns with HR early and repeatedly; changes were temporary before the organisation returned to the same patterns.
- She has moved into a wider policy role and now attends forums with the British Council, UNESCO and LUMS.

3 What She Said Worked

- **Learning and growth.** She opened with gratitude. She was given responsibility early, which forced agility and rapid learning — new platforms, and extensive use of AI tools, which she considers valuable going forward.
- **Admin team.** "Doing a wonderful job." She named **Tahir** and **Safdar**. Kitchen, washroom and logistics complaints were acted on swiftly.
- **Flexibility** shown on coach commute matters and community activities.
- **Knowledge sharing** when colleagues return from the field.
- **Socialisation** in the office — "very good."
- **Trust placed in her.** Coaches and RMs, including new joiners, relied on her and spoke to her openly.
- She credited **HR** for eventually understanding her point about representation in the RM selection process.

4 What She Flagged

4.1 — Mistakes repeat. Her opening point: the same mistakes recur in the field, at the office and at leadership level. She raised issues with HR early; corrections held briefly, then the organisation reverted. She linked this to renewal — if a three-year extension is the goal, these cycles need to break.

4.2 — Hiring is inconsistent. Early hiring was random: fresh graduates without relevant degrees or experience. She was explicit that hiring fresh graduates is not itself the problem — the problem is placing people with neither relevant qualification nor experience in front of government. Sometimes a JD existed, sometimes not; criteria were applied inconsistently. During the Planning & Commission visit she saw coaches visibly anxious under questioning about their qualifications and stepped in. She was asked her own qualification; her education degree from LUMS ended the questioning.

4.3 — Promotions follow a different standard. Strict criteria are applied when facing a government audit, but a different protocol governs internal promotion, producing people who cannot be justified externally. She named the promotion of **Haashir** as difficult to justify and said it caused unrest among coaches. She referred to a **Programme Manager** appointment openly questioned in the office as not qualifying for the role.

4.4 — Over-reliance on AI-written assignments. A strong assignment is masking the absence of relevant background, track record and motivation. Her question: are we so reliant on AI that we are ignoring every other factor?

4.5 — Favouritism and no accountability. She said several people joined through references rather than open process. She gave a first-hand example: **Bilal**, then an RM candidate, told her he did not want to join and had not signed his contract. She reported this to **Waqas**; Bilal was persuaded to join, and in her account was subsequently protected and promoted. She said there is no accountability mechanism — no committee, no consequence — and concluded that those who manipulate the situation are the ones who get promoted.

4.6 — Harassment and unfair treatment went unaddressed. She disclosed that she personally experienced a form of harassment early in her tenure. She did not report it at the time — she was unsure whether she was "over-feeling" it and did not want to create drama. **She did not name any individual.** She said people who treated others unfairly were protected rather than penalised: moved to different roles, kept in decision-making, and shown on an apparent growth trajectory. She said HR did not listen to those who reported bad treatment, while minor issues raised by others were picked up.

> **Restricted.** Section 4.6 should be handled by HR / People & Culture leadership and not circulated with the rest of this record.

4.7 — Leadership strategy versus FDE compliance. She said the experimental, product-led approach conflicts with FDE's traditional, contract-bound expectations — FDE reads the contract and is not interested in experiments. She raised this repeatedly, was labelled as having an "FDE mindset" and, in her words, "snubbed every time." The Planning & Commission audit subsequently flagged non-compliance with contract terms. She also noted the government requirement for full-time availability, while the programme was in part being run from outside the country. On expansion: ICT is the base where everything was built and tested, and she questioned pursuing Tanzania and Palestine — structurally very different contexts — while the base remains unresolved.

4.8 — No demonstrable impact or external visibility. In forums with the British Council, UNESCO and LUMS she has never heard NIETE or Taleemabad mentioned. When a Joint Secretary asked her directly about impact, she could offer only stories, not concrete numbers. She described constant system churn, with each new system replacing the last, little data reflected back, and teachers and school heads unhappy — which coaches and RMs have been reporting.

4.9 — Workspace. There is no quiet space to concentrate; the conference room is taken by meetings and the office by interviews. She sometimes sat outside in the heat to do focused work.

5 Individuals She Named

NAME	CONTEXT	WHAT SHE SAID	REF
Haashir	ADVERSE	His promotion was difficult to justify and caused unrest among coaches.	4.3
Bilal	ADVERSE	As an RM candidate he told her he did not want to join and had not signed his contract; was then persuaded to join, and subsequently protected and promoted.	4.5
Waqas	NEUTRAL	The person she reported Bilal's reluctance to. Named as the recipient of her report, not as a subject of complaint.	4.5
Programme Manager (role only)	ADVERSE	An appointment openly questioned in the office as not qualifying for the role. She did not name the individual.	4.3
No one named	RESTRICTED	On her own experience of harassment she named no individual.	4.6
Tahir, Safdar	POSITIVE	Named in her praise of the Admin team — swift and supportive.	3
Ali	POSITIVE	She suggested the recording be shared with him, saying she has hope on that side.	6

> **Note on the adverse mentions.** These are one person's account, unverified, and the individuals named have not been given any opportunity to respond. The names are drawn from the recording's automated transcript and summary rather than clear audio, and should be checked against the recording before being repeated. This document records what was said; it does not establish that it is correct.

6 What She Asked For

Recorded as she put them — these are her own requests, not recommendations added afterwards.

- **The RM selection now under way should not be decided on AI-submitted assignments.** Track record and motivation must be checked. This was her one explicit, time-bound request.
- **Fix the hiring process** — a consistent filter, and a JD for every role.
- **Treat the ICT programme as a commitment to children, not a testing ground.** Experimenting on those children is unfair to them.
- **Stop building everything from scratch.** Learn from established international research and from organisations already doing this work well — she named **TCF** — and build on their learning.
- **Create quiet focus space** in the office if the floor can be expanded.
- She suggested the recording be **shared with Ali**, saying she has hope on that side because they come from a different system and may act on the improvements.
- She said she hopes this feedback is acted on this time, having raised much of it before without visible outcome.

7 In Her Own Words

> *"In this office, over two and a half years, my experience has been that there is no space for honesty and hard work in this office."*

> *"I have seen mistakes being repeated again and again, not just in the field, but also at the office level, at the leadership level."*

> *"Where have the people who kept this kind of unfair treatment with coaches and RMs been penalised? They haven't been penalised anywhere."*

> *"If you are promoting a person just to show face, and you need four other people to support him, then why do you even go for that hiring?"*

> *"I started feeling like I was some salesperson whose product it is that has to be sold."*

Tahir Saleem

Document control. Record of the exit conversation held on 21 September 2026, compiled from the recording and its automated transcript. Quotes are reproduced as captured. Confidential internal HR record. Section 4.6 is restricted to HR / People & Culture leadership.